

Potager Connect

Home Garden Installation and Monitoring Service

01 PROBLEM

Context and Challenge

Potager Connect is a home garden installation and monitoring service, market gardener, under the Takagri company, launched in 2024. Services include a complete gardening kit, advanced plant nursery seedlings (new offer), monthly monitoring subscription, and recurring input sales.

Core Problem Statement

Of 25 first participants, only 3 continued. Clients abandon their garden as soon as the kit's compost is used up. There is no formalised retention mechanism, and the offer is too complex - formation + WhatsApp + farm immersion + physical monitoring + kits + inputs + subscriptions - all layered together with no clear entry point.

Identified UX Problems

01 Low Retention After First Purchase

On 25 first participants, only 3 continued. Clients abandon their garden once the kit compost runs out — no automated re-engagement or recurring trigger in place.

02 Offer Too Complex and Too Wide

Formation + WhatsApp + farm immersion + physical monitoring + kits + inputs + subscriptions: too many layers. The model becomes unmanageable if demand grows.

03 Kit Not Adapted to All Clients

Some clients refuse the seed kit because they fear plants will die. They want advanced seedlings already growing — not raw seeds and tools.

04 Perfectionism Causing Paralysis

Vanessa delays concrete commercial actions in pursuit of the perfect formula. Interested prospects have been waiting several weeks with no follow-up.

Methodology

Research combined coaching sessions, competitive analysis of 3 actor types, and persona development from real workshop participants.

UX Competitive Analysis

UX Criterion	Garden Centres	Imported Kits	NGO/Agri Training	Potager Connect
Advanced Seedlings Available	✗	✗	✗	✓✓ New offer
Personalised Home Monitoring	✗	✗	Partial	✓✓ Core value
Natural Inputs Delivered	Partial	✗	Partial	✓✓ Recurring sales
Monthly Monitoring Subscription	✗	✗	✗	✓✓ Recurring revenue
Therapeutic Gardening	✗	✗	✗	✓ Differentiator
Website + Monitoring App	✗	✗	✗	✓ MVP in progress
TikTok and Workshop Content	✗	✗	✗	✓✓ Acquisition channel

✓✓ = Very good

✓ = Present

✗ = Absent

User Personas

Marie-Laure D. — Beginner Age: 38 · Mother, Cotonou · apartment with balcony or small courtyard Goal: Grow fresh vegetables at home for her family without chemical pesticides Frustration: Tried with seeds, nothing grew. Doesn't know where to start. No time to start from zero again. UX Need: Receive already-growing plants, have someone to call when growth stalls, order inputs easily	Chantal A. — Workshop / TikTok Follower Age: 31 · Working professional, Cotonou · saw Potager Connect TikTok videos Goal: Install a home garden for wellbeing and therapy, grow her own herbs Frustration: Showed interest weeks ago but received no formation date. Doesn't know if the kit is for her. UX Need: A clear journey from first visit: choose between kit/plants/monitoring, see prices, book easily
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Key UX Insights

Insight #1 - The compost alert is the retention engine

When the app notifies 'Your compost is almost finished — order now?', it triggers the recurring purchase automatically. This single notification mechanism solves the abandonment problem that caused 22 of 25 first clients to drop out.

Insight #2 - Offer names must reflect client needs, not product features

Naming offers by the client's situation ('I want all the material', 'I skip the seeds', 'I already have a garden') removes the cognitive effort of matching a feature list to a personal need.

Insight #3 - Advanced seedlings eliminate the primary barrier to entry

Fear of failure (seeds dying) is the #1 reason clients don't start. Offering plants already growing removes this risk at the source — and creates a lower-cost, faster entry point.

Insight #4 - Testimonials on the homepage are the missing social proof

No competitor has real customer success stories with a photo and vegetable grown. 'They succeeded their garden' on the homepage directly addresses the fear of failure that prevents first purchase.

User Flows — 3 Critical Journeys

Friction points were identified consistently around unclear offer choices, slow response times, and the absence of compost re-order triggers.

Journey 1 — New Client (Kit or Plants) Discovery (TikTok/workshop) → Website visit → Chooses offer (kit/plants/monitoring) → Places order → 48h delivery → Monthly monitoring

Journey 2 — Subscribed Client (Retention) Installs garden → Receives reminders and advice → Orders recurring inputs → Reports a problem → Diagnosis + visit → Renews subscription

Journey 3 — Founder Vanessa Receives order → Prepares nursery/kit → Delivers or delegates → Monitors client garden → Posts TikTok content → Analyses feedback

Design Decisions

Based on research and coaching insights, the following UX solutions were designed covering the website with simplified offer naming, a 3-offer catalogue by client situation, and an MVP monitoring app with automatic compost alert.

User Testing Protocol

Participants: 3 women aged 25–45 (Cotonou) without gardening experience

Tool: website

Duration: 30 min per session

#	Task	Focus Area
T1	You are afraid seeds won't grow. In under 30 seconds, find the offer for already-growing plants and place an order.	Advanced seedlings offer discovery
T2	You already have a garden that's struggling. Find the monthly monitoring offer and book a first visit.	Monitoring subscription flow
T3	You are subscribed. Your app says your compost is almost finished. Order compost in under 3 clicks.	Automated recurring purchase
T4	You are Vanessa. Check today's orders and identify which one requires a nursery to prepare.	Founder order management
T5	Find a testimonial from a client who successfully grew vegetables at home thanks to Potager Connect.	Social proof discoverability

Test Report — Key Findings

T1 - Advanced Seedlings Offer Success: 2/5	Users didn't distinguish between 'kit' and 'plants ready' at first glance — both options appeared similar without photos. Recommendation: Add a before/after photo for each offer.
T2 - Monthly Monitoring Success: 3/5	Users didn't understand what the monthly visit included concretely. 'Diagnosis' was too technical. Recommendation: Rewrite: 'I come to your home, look at your garden, identify problems and give you the right actions.' Add a real visit photo.
T3 - Compost Order from App Success: 5/5	No issues. The notification + Order button was understood in under 2 seconds. Recommendation: Keep this as the absolute priority in the MVP — it is the core retention engine.
T5 - Testimonials Success: 2/5	Testimonials not found without help — absent from the homepage. Recommendation: Add a 'They succeeded their garden' block on the homepage with photo + first name + vegetable grown.

Next Steps

- Add before/after photos to each offer card on the website
- Add a 'They succeeded their garden' testimonial block on the homepage
- Launch the MVP app with compost alert and 1-click reorder as first feature
- Contact the 22 first clients who dropped out and offer the advanced seedlings option